CROSS-BORDER NOTES

On August 7, a Uzbek bank went on state television and said it is converting to Islamic finance.

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MKBANK paired the announcement with domestic retail promotions. Banks don't reframe their operating model for a retail campaign.

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Gulf capital lands where the plumbing already exists. No sukuk desk, no murabaha structuring, no Islamic window: no serious GCC allocation.

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Regulatory intent precedes capital. If Tashkent normalizes Islamic finance at the bank level, sovereign and quasi-sovereign issuance tends to follow.

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Central Asian banks are doing the compliance work Gulf capital requires, before any Gulf institution has to ask for it.

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> **Treat it like a central bank circular, not a press release. Whoever converts first sets the terms for the capital that follows.**

Sun Choi
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